



PUBG x Tera Crossover

The upcoming crossover will bring PUBG cosmetics to Tera, as against Tera's fantasy world to PUBG. <https://digit.in/mar19-75>



Netflix bought one of the biggest movies

Netflix buys Wandering Earth, a movie which has already surpassed half a billion dollars at the box office in China within 2 weeks of release. <https://digit.in/mar19-76>

What's next on the horizon?

Currently, I am in class 12, so my main objective is to get into a good college after this. I will go into fields related to finance and pursue coding & stuff as a 'sidekick' or say as a part-time thing. I also plan to participate in Google Summer of Code and some other events in the coming years.

Any advice for folks participating in next year's Code-in?

As the organizers themselves say that quality > quantity, I would reiterate the same statement. Try and do tasks in such a way that you yourself believe



that you 'completed' the task. Don't aim to do as many tasks as possible. Instead, aim to do tasks in a way as best as possible. This will also increase the chances of your tasks getting accepted

without any requirement for rework. Also, choose your organisation wisely. If you have prior experience with the organisation's products, it may turn out to be helpful when you work on tasks. Or, if you feel that you are really confident in a particular programming language, you can choose an organisation which uses that language in their code base. Moreover, be patient when you have submitted your task for approval. Since the mentors might be from different time zones, it will take time to get a task approved after submission. That's all. Best of luck for your participation! 📌

COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTIONS

This month we have **Muthukrishnan Shreenivasan**, an avid technology enthusiast who enjoys blogging about computer science concepts. Currently in 10th Grade, the young Digit Reader hails from Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu. Here's a little primer on API written by him.

A PRIMER ON APIS.

Connectivity is amazing. We are all getting used to the instant connectivity that puts the world in our fingertips. You may wonder how the data gets from here to there that enables us to book movie tickets or make a hotel reservation with just a single tap. The unnoticed hero here is API.

What is an API ?

API stands for Application Programming Interface. API is a 'software to software' interface which acts as a "go - between" that takes requests and tells the system what you want to do and returns back the response.

To make you understand better let's take an example. Imagine that you are going to a food joint. When you take your seat inside the joint a waiter takes your orders, then he takes your preferred order to the chef to prepare your food and when the food is ready the waiter returns to you with your preferred food. In this case "The Waiter" acts as the API, the chef acts as the system from whom the waiter or API is delivering the re-

sponse. API's have become so valuable that now they comprise a large part of business revenue. Large companies such as Google, Expedia, Ebay, Amazon are just some of the major companies which make money out of their APIs.

Understanding further with a real life example of API. Let's say that you want to book a movie with third party movie booking applications. (eg. bookmyshow). It asks you for a specific movie, date, time and number of seats. After you've entered your preferred movie, date, time and number of seats, it tells you the theaters available for that particular requirements. Here the movie booking website uses API to get data from other websites. As a user you are just seeing one interface, in this case it is the movie booking application. But behind scenes many applications are working together with more APIs.

Are APIs safe ?

Some people may wonder whether APIs are safe, well APIs never expose all your data to the server, the server is also not fully exposed to your phones. Instead

both the the server and the phone reveal only packets of data. They just reveal the data which is necessary.

Does API really matter ?

A great API brings a great degree of functionality, power and versatility to the existing program, application or website. They increase the speed and reliability of communication between programs. Anytime you've seen a like button at a youtube video or a google maps pinned to a webpage, you are looking at the fruits of API.

APIs can save countless number of human hours, this kind of advantage is always appreciated by programmers and bussiness professionals alike. Whether or not you've recognized and had seen APIs in action, odds are you've been happy or grateful of using an API in daily life.

Popular examples of APIs.

1. Google maps - Google Maps API allow developers to insert maps into their own applications.
2. Instagram - Instagram's API allows developers to incorporate photos, pull tags, and view trending photos on their own applications.
3. Youtube - YouTube's API allows developers to insert video into their websites. 📌